# 9.14 Compartment Syndrome

| Assessment | Nursing Diagnosis | Plan / Expected Outcome | Nursing Interventions | Evaluation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Subjective**<br>• "The pain is getting worse even with injections."<br>**Objective**<br>• Pain when the muscle is passively stretched<br>• Compartment tense and swollen<br>• Pins and needles | **ACTUAL**<br>**Ineffective peripheral tissue perfusion** related to increased compartment pressure as evidenced by severe pain, tense swelling and paresthesia. | Circulation restored after fasciotomy. | • Report this at once.<br>• Keep the limb level with the heart, not raised.<br>• Take off or loosen tight dressings or the cast, as ordered.<br>• Get him ready for fasciotomy. | Circulation restored: **goal met**. |
| **Subjective**<br>• Pain 10/10<br>**Objective**<br>• Opioids do not touch the pain<br>• Pain on passive stretch | **ACTUAL**<br>**Acute pain** related to ischemia as evidenced by pain out of proportion. | Pain relieved after decompression. | • Give analgesia as prescribed.<br>• Check pain often.<br>• Pain that will not settle must be reported at once. | Relieved: **goal met**. |
| **Subjective**<br>• *No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• Fasciotomy wound<br>• Muscle exposed | **RISK**<br>**Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: open fasciotomy wounds. | Wounds stay free of infection. | • Use sterile dressings.<br>• Watch his temperature and how the wound looks.<br>• Give antibiotics as prescribed. | No infection: **goal met**. |